



### **A BERLIOZ CONCERT**

A caricature of Hector Berlioz published by Austrian journal Wiener Theaterzeitung in 1846 shows the composer conducting a deafening concert with an exploding cannon, and chaos and panic in the crowd; formally dressed concert-goers cover their ears against the terrible din.

During the course of the 1830s, Berlioz achieved professional recognition, although lack of money always remained a problem. In 1834, at the request of Niccolò Paganini, he composed *Harold in Italy*, a symphony with solo viola. Paganini never performed the work, but the composers remained on friendly terms and Paganini later gave Berlioz 20,000 francs to finance one of his other projects.